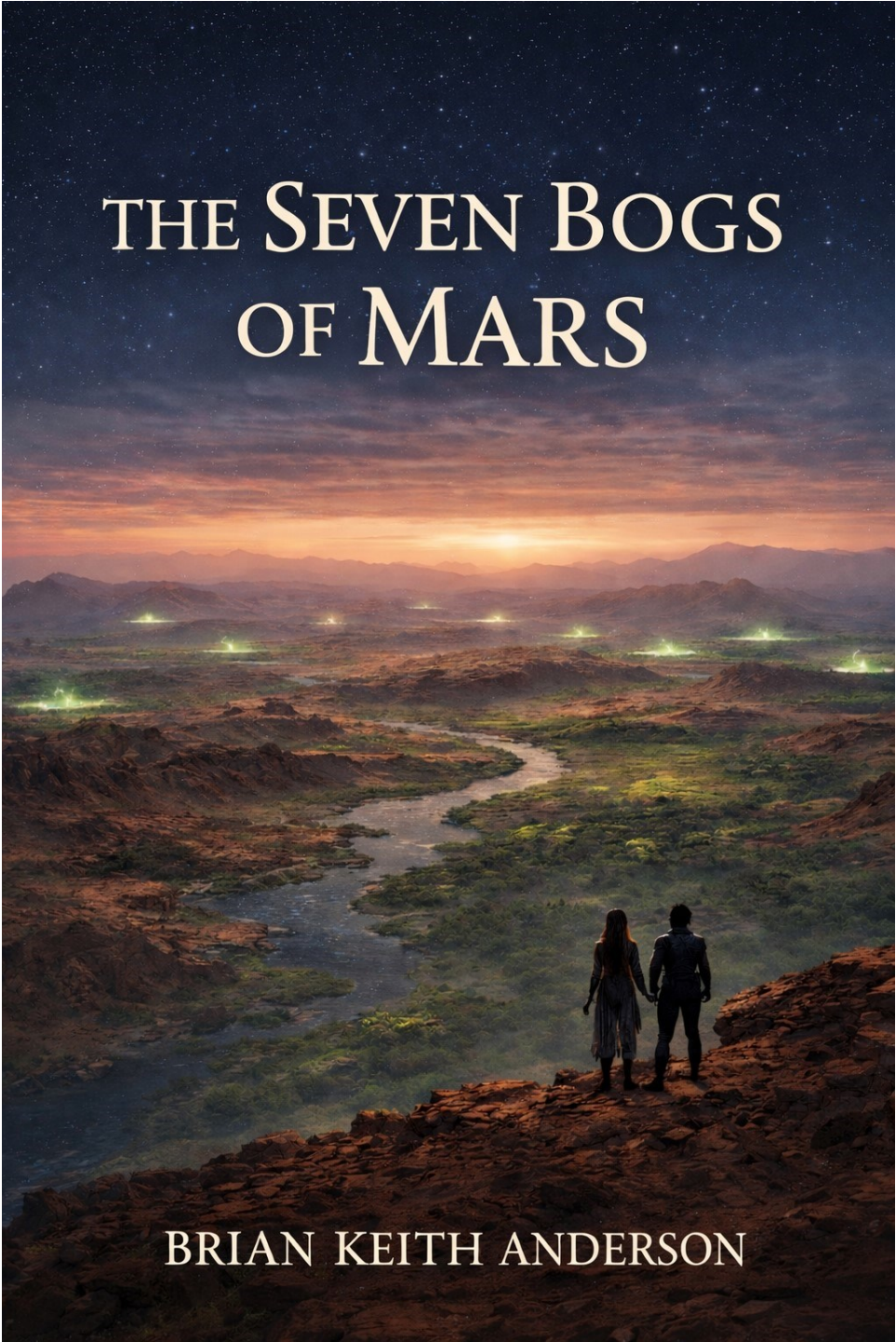




THE SEVEN BOGS OF MARS

BRIAN KEITH ANDERSON

THE SANCTUARY OF SEVEN BOGS

Book One of The Seven Bogs of Mars

By

B.K. Anderson

THE SEVEN BOGS OF MARS

Book One — *The Sanctuary of Seven Bogs*

Seven living Bogs.

Seven ancient gates.

One shared future between Earth and Mars

The Seven Bogs of Mars

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DEDICATION

For the land that remembers,
for the bees that teach us how to listen,
and for those who walk gently between worlds.

EPIGRAPH

What is buried is not dead.

What sleeps is not forgotten.

What waits will answer when life returns in balance.

AUTHOR'S NOTE

This is the first book in **The Seven Bogs of Mars**.

It begins with one living sanctuary awakening and expands toward seven.

These stories are not about conquering a world but learning how to belong to it.

The journey continues.

— B.K. Anderson

CHAPTER ONE — THE SLEEPER

The silence of Mars was not empty.

It had texture — thin as breath, wide as distance — a stillness that carried memory the way deep water carries light. Dust lay soft over the ancient basin, but beneath it the ground was not inert. It waited.

At the center of the first Bog, Saxifraga rested where land and sky met without touching. She was neither buried nor standing, neither bound nor free. She was held — suspended in a living pause that had lasted longer than human history.

The Bog around her breathed in a rhythm so slowly that centuries could pass between heartbeats.

For ages, nothing changed.

Then, imperceptibly, something did.

A tremor moved through the field — not an earthquake, not wind, not gravity — but a signal that was remembered rather than received. The Bog stirred before Saxifraga did, as if it had been listening all along.

Water shifted beneath the surface. Roots tightened. The air above her shimmered faintly, like heat over a distant horizon.

And in that moment, the Sleeper felt it.

Not danger.

Not command.

Not alarm.

A call.

Soft, ancient, and unmistakable.

The world was asking to live again.

Saxifraga opened her eyes.

For a long moment she did not move.

Her gaze did not search for the horizon; it gathered it.

Dust did not cling to her skin — it remembered her.

Light reached her differently now. Not as illumination, but as recognition.

Above her, the thin Martian sky held its breath.

Beneath her, the Bog shifted again — deeper this time — a slow, tidal movement of water through channels older than maps. Tiny glimmers moved under the surface, like fireflies caught in dark water. They were not insects; they were currents of living coherence, the circulatory system of the land itself.

Saxifraga inhaled.

It was not air she drew in, but awareness.

With that first breath, she felt three things at once:

the wound of Mars,

the patience of the Bog,

and the absence of companionship.

The Bog had endured perfectly.

That was the problem.

She lifted her hand — not abruptly, but as one lifted something fragile from water — and placed her palm against the ground. The surface yielded, not in weakness but in invitation.

A vibration traveled up her arm and into her chest.

Images rose without effort:

— ancient corridors beneath the basin, lit by a sun that no longer warmed this world;

— voices speaking in a language made of resonance rather than words;

— departure ships lifting into a sky thicker than today's;

— seven basins seeded, sealed, and left to wait.

None of it was grief alone.

It was intention.

When she withdrew her hand, the Bog remained in contact — not physically, but relatively as if a thread had been tied between them.

Saxifraga stood.

For the first time in an age, her feet touched the living surface.

The ground did not tremble.

It welcomed.

She turned slowly, taking in the horizon. Dust plains rolled away in muted ochre, but beneath that stillness she could *sense* six other hearts — distant, sleeping, aching for circulation.

One was not enough.

The thought did not arrive as logic; it arrived as necessity.

A soft sound moved across the basin — part wind, part water, part breath.

The Bog spoke without speech, offering its knowledge in texture, temperature, and rhythm.

Saxifraga listened.

What she heard was not catastrophe. It was isolation.

The system had been too correct for too long. Balanced, yes — but sealed. Stable, yes — but alone. A world that knew how to endure but had forgotten how to exchange.

She closed her eyes again, not to sleep, but to widen her listening.

Somewhere beyond Mars — across space, across memory — another world still carried living movement. Gates that had not gone silent. People who had kept certain passages awake through continuity of care.

Gaia.

The name did not feel foreign. It felt familial.

When she opened her eyes this time, her decision was already present.

She did not yet speak it aloud.

She did not need to.

The Bog knew.

A faint brightening traveled outward from her position, a slow pulse that crossed the basin like dawn moving across water.

Above, the sky thinned further, as if making room.

And in that widening, a path became imaginable — not a road, not a tunnel, but a fold of resonance linking two worlds that had long been separated.

The Sleeper was no longer only a watcher.

She was beginning.

“Thank you for reading sample”